

What Will Hours of Worship Do in You

The Life That Began in the Father Became Fellowship in Us

Last week, when we were teaching on worship, we saw that it is because of the individuality we grow into in the life He gave us that we enter into individual fellowship with God. That fellowship gives Him pleasure. It brings Him much, much pleasure.

The life we received, the life that caused us to be born again, began its journey in the Father. Jesus said the Father has life in Himself, and He gave to the Son to have life in Himself. We are talking about His humanity, not His deity.

When that life was transferred to Jesus, it took the form of a human spirit. That human spirit was born spiritually alive, fathered alive. The only alteration that took place in that life was that it first existed in the Father, as part of the Father and part of His Spirit, and then was born into Jesus.

Then Jesus turned around, and the same life that was in Him is the life we received when we were quickened together with Him, made alive, and seated in heavenly places with Him. I am speaking of His humanity, because the part we are seated with is His glorified humanity.

It is interesting that in John 4, when Jesus described what the Father was after, He said, "God is a Spirit." He presented Him as a Spirit. He did not just say "spirit"; He said, "God is a Spirit."

Because He labeled Him as such, His conclusion was that God seeketh such to worship Him. The people He was outlining as those He sought to worship Him had to be qualified by the fact that God Himself is a Spirit. He seeketh such to worship Him in spirit and in truth.

When Jesus said "in spirit and in truth," He was talking about what you and I received when we were born again and received that life from Him that put us back into fellowship with Him.

When He said He seeketh such to worship Him, the seeking He was talking about took four thousand years. It involved a master plan that included everything God was, everything we were, and everything we had become. He waited out the dispensations of four thousand years and finally, by becoming a man Himself as the second Person of the Godhead, He changed Adam's race, all who would accept Him, back into something that could fellowship with Him.

The part of the human race that was put out of fellowship with God was the human spirit. It went from a new nature to a death nature, from a sin-free nature to a death nature.

Jesus identified God as Spirit and said He seeketh such to worship Him. The only kind of worship and fellowship He sought would come from the attributes and things born into your spirit when you were born again. Only those forces and attributes you now possess in your spirit can afford Him that fellowship.

When He is seeking such to worship Him, He is seeking something from you that can only come from the spiritual realm.

That makes it absolutely impossible for the Old Testament saints to give Him what He desired when He used that phrase, "seeketh such." Jesus isolated Him as Spirit to let you know why Old Testament saints could not worship Him as a Spirit. The only fellowship God was seeking came from the nature you became because of the life that made its journey from inside the Father, took the form of a human spirit inside Jesus, and then took the form of life and nature inside you when you were born again.

The Spirit Man Is a Person With Capacity to Know God

There are several aspects to the human spirit.

If I were to step out of my body, and God held my physical body standing there so my spiritual body could stand next to it, you would see that my spiritual body has fingers, hands, eyes, nose, mouth, emotions, and everything else.

"I do not think so."

We have used the word spirit mystically. But when the rich man in hell was buried, his body was in the grave, yet he had eyes to lift up. The spirit man has eyes. He wanted Lazarus, who was in Abraham's bosom, to dip the tip of his finger in water, so the spirit man has fingers. He wanted the water put on his tongue, so the spirit man has a tongue.

If the spirit man has all those things, he also has a mind.

If I held up my spirit finger and asked you, "What is it made of?" what would you say?

"Well, you are a spirit."

Yes, but what is my finger made of?

"It is made out of spirit."

I am a spirit. When you look at my flesh body and I hold my physical finger up, what am I made of? You would say flesh. Break it down, and you get molecules, compounds, atomic structure, atoms, electrons, protons, and neutrons. Now they have found particles so small they pass through the earth because, to them, there are huge caverns to move through.

My physical man breaks down to matter, but when you look at me, do you say, "You are flesh"? No. You say, "You are a human being." The body is what you are looking at.

When you look at my spirit man, what do you say? What am I made of? I may consist of spirit. The substance I am made of may be spirit. But that is my spiritual body you are looking at. I am still a person. I have a mind.

When we say my spirit received a new nature, part of that nature in me has the capacity to discern spiritual things. There is a hunger to know and understand, and along with that, a capacity to understand. I can discern spiritual things out of that part of the makeup of my human spirit.

The basis of it now is a new nature. I no longer have the nature I once had. I have this new nature. One aspect of my new nature is the ability to discern and understand spiritual things. I have a capacity to be taught, to sit here and be taught, and to understand things about God because I now have a part of me that can discern Him.

Agape Is Not Merely Taught, It Is Born In and Developed

With my natural intellect, I can learn mathematics to a degree. I can discern it and understand it. But when it comes to love, love cannot be taught to me in the same way. Even in the natural man, love cannot simply be taught. All you can do is teach what love is like, what it is supposed to be, and how it is supposed to treat your friends or your wife, depending on what kind of love you are talking about.

My spirit has the ability to discern spiritual things, but love is something you have. Even in the natural, when you say, "I fell in love with somebody," that is not something you deliberately developed first. It is a capacity you had, and then it manifested.

It is the same with your spirit.

When you received a new nature, there were many parts to that nature. One part discerns and understands spiritual things and can be taught. But you cannot be taught into having love in your new nature the same way you learn facts. It is a force born into you, and it can be developed.

Thank God that part can be developed. It is the part that came from God and is part of our nature from Him. Not only can we understand things, but we can operate in the love of God because that part was born into our new nature.

I need to discern and teach my spirit about the things of God. But even though agape is born in me, it can still be developed.

This is what I have found hours of worship to do.

Worship Begins in Knowledge and Opens the Well of Love

Hours of worship seem like suspending myself in His presence.

At first it starts in the realm of knowledge. I know I am supposed to do it. I am supposed to tell Him how much I love Him, worship Him, and glorify Him. But parts of my intellect were hard to get past.

I would think about this all-encompassing God who knows everything, and here I am in a prayer closet telling Him over and over that I magnify Him, glorify Him, and love Him. He is the all-encompassing, all-knowing Creator. He has the intellect that put the atom together. It seemed strange that a little creature like me could keep telling Him, "I love You. I worship You. I glorify You," and somehow that brought Him pleasure.

After a while I found out it did. His presence would come and begin to magnify itself.

When it does, it begins to minister to that part of my spirit. Not the intellect, not the hunger for knowledge, not the ability to discern, "This is God," or "This is not God." There is something born in that part of my new nature that has agape, compassion, the part that can love with the love of God.

This is the well. This is the well the Father loves to come to.

When you are worshiping and thanking Him, your words can seem shallow. It is a language we learn with our intellect, yet we are trying to express what we feel with our heart. Sometimes we do not feel much love for God. In fact, we may feel more flesh than anything else, so we almost have to order ourselves in.

The words may seem dry. Here is this intellectual language you are trying to use in the presence of God to express how you are supposed to feel when you do not feel that way. Then you think, "If He is so smart, He knows what I am doing."

When I first tried to break into worship, I thought, "He thinks I am a shyster. I am conning Him. I want Him to think I am worshiping Him and that I love Him."

To make it worse, you hear everybody preach, "If you want to receive from God, worship. Ask Him for something and then worship Him for it."

When you get into that and start worshiping Him, the devil pulls everything on you.

"You hypocrite. The only reason you are worshiping God is because you know He is going to give you things. You hypocrite."

Then I had to fight that off. I would try to convince Him, "No, no, I am just here to tell You how much I love You."

Then I could hear the devil say, "Yes, but in the back of your mind, you know you are going to get things."

Dry Worship Exposed Motives Without Stopping Fellowship

In those early days, when God had laid me out and ordered me into the closet for a certain amount of hours, one thing He knew about me was that if He told me to do it and I knew it was Him, I would obey Him.

So when the going got rough in there, and I mean really rough, it felt like God had forsaken me. It felt like there was nothing but a room full of devils sitting around in chairs watching my hypocrisy.

Yet deep inside, I knew it was right.

I worshiped Him, and the devil said, "Deep down, you know why you are doing this. It is not because you really love God like that. It is because you are trying to make things work. You are trying to make faith work. All these things are coming against you, and you are hoping this is the answer. You are hoping everything is going to turn."

He probably stayed on me like that for about ten days.

I was sure glad I fought, because last February, when I was in fasting and prayer and worshipping around the clock, there were seasons when I prayed in tongues, but I was worshipping a lot. I had a long, dry spell. I just kept worshipping Him because by then I knew it was developing something in me. I had already seen what it had done in the miracle realm.

Even though for seasons I would not feel Him in the closet, it seemed that when I came out in public, He showed up like He never had before.

After about ten days of battling that on and off, I finally told God, "You know I have need of this. You know I have need of that. I know You know everything, so You know it is in the back of my mind. But even though it is there, I do not care. To me, I am worshipping You because I know I am supposed to, and I know it gets me closer to You. I know in the back of my mind I am thinking I will benefit in this and this and this. But as much as it is in me, that is not why I am in the closet worshipping You. I know You know that. So I am just going to override all of that and worship You anyway."

And I did.

After that, He began to come and stay on me longer and longer, fellowshiping with me longer and longer.

Then I found out there was healing in that presence that came and left, then came and stayed. It stays most of the time now.

However, I do know that when I am out of prayer or worship for too long, with hectic day-and-night meetings and traveling, I get to where when I try to spend time with Him, I fall asleep on my feet. That is how busy I get. But I have found that most of the time, very shortly, His presence is there.

The Anointing of the Believer Appeared After the Office Gift Lifted

The first times this presence showed up, it did so in a peculiar way. He waited until after the anointing on my gifting had lifted.

For years, after teaching in a service, I would step out knowing the next thing He was supposed to do was operate in the gifts. I would finish preaching, close my Bible, lift my hands, and thank God for a minute. The gift would begin to manifest: gifts of healings, miracles, words of knowledge. All of a sudden I would start talking about this person and that person, and miracles and healings would come.

After a while it would start winding down, and that anointing would lift off me. I could not do it anymore, and I knew it was time to close the service. That anointing would not be on me again until I went back into a service.

Even when I prayed for people, I would worship God, lay hands on them, and generally it was just a prayer of one believer to another. It had nothing to do with the office.

But in Virginia, they put bales of cloths on the altar because that anointing seemed to follow.

When Scripture says God wrought special miracles through Paul's body, and they took aprons and cloths from him, we often say God came to do something special with Paul. But if you think the people he ministered to through those cloths were special people, they were not. If you think Paul was special in the sense that God respected his person, he was not. God is no respecter of persons.

Since Jesus said, "It is finished," and the whole work was complete, everything was made available to the Body of Christ. God has been trying to give me everything I need to reach the person next to me.

There is no generation that ever went to hell for whom hell was not just as hot as it was for the generation before and the generation after. If God plays special favorites for certain generations, then it means it was His decision for earlier generations to go to hell because He did not play those favorites for them.

When Scripture says God wrought special miracles by Paul's hands, it means Paul had touched God with compassion more thoroughly than almost anyone before or since. God could take a cloth from Paul's body, connect that cloth to the hole in heaven Paul had opened with compassion, trace that cloth back to Paul, and in that remote place follow his prayers and do more miracles than the physical presence of most evangelists I know.

Hallelujah.

Special miracles.

How many people do you know who, when given the choice, would say, "Yes, I will save that person. I will save them. I know how much You love them, and I love my brethren, my kinsmen, the Jews"?

That was Paul.

Agape Grows Where God's Presence Occupies the Spirit

Here is a man with that little force of agape born into his new nature. Like any attribute in infancy, it was born there. Some people go on hating, dividing, causing strife and emulations, because that nature never gets strong enough in them to control their flesh.

Yet this nature is born into us. We will not let it develop. We carry on with hatred, emulation, strife, and all kinds of things, while born again with the capacity not only to be taught, but to return the love.

He said the same love the Father loves Jesus with is the same love He loves me with. So I have a capacity not only for Him to love me with that love, but for me to manifest that love. There is something there that can be developed.

Of course, seeing what the Word says and confessing that you have no strife will help in the process of transformation of soul and spirit. But I have found that the longer I let God come in His presence and occupy that developing part of my spirit, the part that can develop agape and love, the more I become like Him.

A person always transforms into and becomes like the one he spends the most time with.

How did I get God to come?

Sometimes I feel Him a little when I am praying in tongues. I feel His favor. Sometimes I feel Him when I am confessing the Word. I feel it pleases Him. I feel surges of faith. Sometimes when I am praying in tongues, excitement comes up, and I get excited about what I am praying out. The only problem is I wish I knew what I was excited about.

But when I am worshiping, and it becomes a baptism of His presence, exceeding joy begins to build in me. Incredible presence. A high feeling. A very strong feeling of well-being, like, "If God be for me, who can be against me?"

I admit, not many have broken into that degree. I understand that.

I was talking to a man who does nothing but lead praise and worship on an international level. He is on television quite often with some of the greatest ministers in the world. This man is really good.

We went out to eat, and he wanted to know, "What do you do?"

I said, "I have been breaking into worship lately as another limb to the Born-Again Trail."

He is the professional on worship. I am not. Because of my lack of talent, I am not called to lead other people into worship and open creation up to God. Obviously, I am not called to do that. Even though I hold a position of authority here, and I do it anyway, nobody can tell me not to. All they can do is leave.

But this person is called to do it.

He said, "What do you do?"

I said, "First of all, you might as well know that most of the books put out on worship are wrong."

I do not say that from lack of experience. I am talking about about thirty years of ministry, and not many of those years have been without prayer. Sometimes I speak from a mountain of knowledge and wisdom as far as overshooting is concerned. I overshoot. Sometimes you do not have the basis to understand some of the statements, so you look at me like a cow at a new gate. But eventually I will get back to it.

I said, "A lot of your books are wrong about worship because they teach that 'in spirit and in truth' is a realm you break into."

Then I explained that it is a positional truth. Old Testament saints could not worship Him in spirit and in truth. You can. They cannot. It is positional. God is a Spirit, and they could not worship Him out of a nature in their spirit. You can. They did not have agape that could be developed. You do.

When I use the word agape, I am speaking of the love that emanates from the new nature. Sometimes in the New Testament, the same Greek word is used where sinners love those who love them. Jesus said sinners do the same in the realm of loaning and borrowing. He was saying the love we have is supposed to keep doing good even when nothing is returned.

The sinner does not have the nature of God to develop in that way. The communion God is seeking from you as a Spirit is the ability inside you to fellowship with Him and love Him out of your capacity as His son.

Positional Worship Receives God Before Feelings Arrive

I told him, "First of all, that teaching is wrong. It is positional truth."

One of the great teachers of worship wrote a book on it. His brother is quite famous, so I grabbed the book. He talked about a day when he cleared time to go in and worship God, but never broke through. He never got "in the Spirit." The next day it was spontaneous, and he got "in the Spirit," because, he said, it is not by your works.

I said, "That is not what 'in spirit' means."

"In spirit" is when, out of your new nature, you go into God's presence, lift your hands, and begin to worship Him. Your born-again spirit might be in bad shape, like somebody pulled a tomato plant out, threw it in the yard, and looked at it two days later. That may be what your spirit looks like, disconnected from its source of food.

But when you start worshipping Him as a born-again person, immediately God begins to attempt to fellowship with you. It may take Him a while, but I can guarantee you that the less you feel like you are getting through, the more you may be getting through, because of the sacrifice it takes on your part to stay in there and tell Him how much you love Him when you cannot feel a thing.

"I just could not seem to break through."

What do you mean? You could not get God to come to your old dead tomato plant in three minutes? It needs a little resurrection first.

Good point. It could use some Miracle-Gro.

He will have times of mercy and grace on you and baptize your senses for a little while. Sometimes when you think, "I am not going to make it," a little sensual stimulation will come along, and you say, "He is really here."

But His intention is to get into fellowship and begin to glorify and magnify Himself in the part of your spirit where love was born. It grows and grows and grows until more of God can have it.

Finally, your little mason jar is too small, and God says, "I am going to have to get a gallon jar." After a while, He needs the big tower over the city that feeds water to the city, because that is the only thing that will hold the great capacity you have for His love. That is your spirit.

Healing Flowed When Worship Touched God With the Spirit

It is nice to find out that when He comes like that, with such a presence that you feel Him all the time, everything He is is in that presence. Everything.

That is when I found out, after the anointing lifted and the preacher's wife could not bend her thumb. I was about to do what I usually did, go through the motions.

"Be brave with my thumb, Brother Roberson."

"Okay."

I was getting ready to go through the motions. I had my pat speech coming up in me: "Jesus..." and "You just worship God every day that it is done."

But I had come through two or three months of worship. My friend who led worship internationally asked, "How long do you do it a day?"

I told him, and he said, "Can you do that?"

I said, "Because He told me."

I will never forget that thumb, because it was the first time I really knew healing was in that presence. I know the difference between the gifting that comes on me and the presence that comes in worship, because I had spent enough time with Him to know.

I reached up, and my hand started going over. I may have lifted my hand for a minute and begun to thank Him for doing it. Then I started to reach over, and my hand just went, whoosh. It came in, just like in the closet.

I reached over to test her thumb. That is all I was going to do, just push on it and see how far it would bend so I would know what I was up against. I grabbed her thumb, and it bent all the way.

I said, "Now, your thumb was jammed?"

"Oh, I could not bend it over that far."

It bent just like that with my finger.

Then the blind boy jumped over. He had been born blind in one eye. His mother and father were elders in the church. He was about sixteen. His eye opened. Same thing.

I realized that was the fellowship He wants to have with everybody. I realized that was the anointing of the believer. The gift had already lifted.

The Father's Life in the Son Became the Life in Us

Look at John 5:26:

For as the Father hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself.

Notice that. The Father has abiding life. You have everlasting life, but the Father has eternal life. His life had no beginning. In the equation of God's life, infinity goes in both directions. He came from nowhere. He always was. The same life He hath always will be.

That is what this word hath means: past, present, and future. He is. "I Am." Always.

This is where He took His life from, a life that always existed and always will.

What did He say about Adam? He called him the son of God. Then Scripture begat the whole genealogy. They were born of Adam. When it got to Jesus, it said He was the Son of God. Everyone in between was not described the same way.

As the Father hath life in Himself, so hath He given to the Son to have life in Himself. The life that was in the Father and always existed now exists in Jesus Himself, independent of the Father, born of Him, yet in Himself.

You have that same life in you now, and it is in yourself, just as individually as the DNA that has your program and made you. There is not another one like it on the whole planet, not one like it since Adam.

Something is so different that they can find you by matching a strand of your DNA. From Adam until now, no two people have had the same strand of DNA. God is that individual, and all of us are that different.

Now that you have been born of God, that life that was in Him is in you.

You might as well know that Joseph was no more Jesus' Father than your earthly father is your true Father after the new birth. All that genealogy represented was the birth of the flesh. What is born of flesh is flesh. What is born of Spirit, or from above, is your spirit.

Your earthly father is no more your ultimate Father than Joseph was Jesus' Father. Joseph represented the first birth, which is of the flesh. Jesus represented the second.

That is why in Matthew Jesus said, "Call no man your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven," and all of you are brethren.

Of course I was born after the flesh, from Adam. But now I have been born from above.

So much for generational curses.

Yet there is a generational curse. What is it? Uninformed preachers preaching the next generation into being uninformed. Ignorant preachers passing ignorant information on to the next gullible generation.

Now they race to the birth of their children to denounce the curses when they come out of the womb. It will not stop there. Somebody will find another degree and take this to the outer limits. "That is why he got sick. I was not there to denounce the curses."

There is only one law I operate under: the law of the Spirit of life. I am free because I ran into Him.